

Word family: **blue** / bluer / bluest / bluish / blueness / blues

Base word: blue

Comparative: bluer

Superlative: bluest

Related forms: bluish, blueness

Related lexical form: blues

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / occasional verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...the quiet rhythm of its body as it disappeared into the **blue water**."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **blue** means the colour blue.

繁體中文： 藍色的；呈現天空或深水常見的藍色色調

中文翻譯：

> "...as it disappeared into the **blue water**."

「.....當牠消失在**藍色的海水**中時。」

Here:

blue water = 藍色的水 / 海水

1. **blue** = the colour blue (顏色) — 藍色的

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Having the colour associated with a clear sky or deep water.

Practice 1 — Original

> "The turtle disappeared into the **blue water**."

「海龜消失在**藍色的海水**中。」

Practice 2

> "She was wearing a **blue** shirt."

「她穿着一件**藍色**恤衫。」

Practice 3

> “The sky turned deep **blue**.”

「天空變成了深**藍色**。」

blue = 呈現藍色色調的

Common:

- * blue sky
- * blue water
- * blue eyes
- * dark blue
- * light blue
- * navy blue

Different shades do not constitute separate meanings.

2. **blue = the colour itself (名詞) — 藍色**

As a noun, **blue** can mean the colour itself.

Practice 4

> “**Blue** is my favourite colour.”

「**藍色**是我最喜歡的顏色。」

Practice 5

> “The painting uses several shades of **blue**.”

「這幅畫用了幾種不同深淺的**藍色**。」

blue = 藍色這種顏色本身

For strict counting, I would merge adjective and noun colour uses under one broad **colour** meaning.

3. **blue = sad / depressed (情緒) — 憂鬱的 ; 心情低落的**

Blue can figuratively mean sad, unhappy, or emotionally low.

Practice 6

> “I’ve been feeling a little **blue** lately.”

「我最近有點**心情低落 / 憂鬱**。」

Practice 7

> “She felt **blue** after her friend moved away.”

「朋友搬走後，她感到很**失落 / 傷感**。」

feel blue = 感到悲傷、低落或憂鬱

This is a major figurative sense.

4. **blue = sexually explicit / indecent (內容) — 色情的 ; 低俗露骨的**

Blue can describe jokes, language, films, or entertainment containing sexually explicit or indecent material.

Practice 8

> “He told a few **blue** jokes.”

「他講了幾個**色情 / 低俗露骨的笑話**。」

Practice 9

> “The comedian’s material became rather **blue**.”

「那位喜劇演員的內容開始變得相當**色情露骨**。」

blue = 含有色情、性暗示或不雅內容的

Common:

* blue joke

* blue humour

* blue language

This is genuinely distinct from the colour sense.

5. **blue = cold or lacking oxygen so the skin looks blue (身體狀態) — 發青的 ; 青紫的**

A person's skin or lips can be described as **blue** when cold or deprived of oxygen.

Practice 10

> "His lips were turning **blue** from the cold."

「他的嘴唇冷得開始**發青 / 青紫**。」

Practice 11

> "Her fingers looked **blue** after being outside for so long."

「她在外面待太久後，手指看起來有點**發青**。」

blue = 因寒冷、血液循環或缺氧等原因，皮膚呈現青藍 / 紫藍色

For core counting, this remains fundamentally a **colour-result** use rather than a completely new semantic concept.

6. **blue = bruised / discoloured (瘀傷) — 青紫的 ; 瘀青的**

This appears especially in the fixed expression **black and blue**.

Practice 12

> "His arm was black and **blue** after the fall."

「他跌倒後手臂**瘀青一片**。」

Practice 13

> "She was bruised black and **blue**."

「她身上**青一塊紫一塊**。」

Again, this is based on physical colour and is better treated as a contextual extension of Meaning

1.

7. **the blue** = the sky or sea (詩意 / 文學) — 藍天 ; 大海

As a noun, **the blue** can poetically refer to the blue sky or sea.

Practice 14

> “The bird disappeared into the **blue**.”

「那隻鳥消失在**藍天**之中。」

Practice 15

> “The boat sailed out into the deep **blue**.”

「小船駛向深邃的**藍色大海**。」

the blue = 因天空或海洋呈藍色 , 而以 blue 代指天空 / 海洋

This is a figurative/metonymic extension of the colour sense.

8. **blues** = sadness / low mood (名詞) — 憂鬱 ; 低落情緒

The plural lexical form **the blues** can mean sadness or depression.

Practice 16

> “She had the Monday morning **blues**.”

「她星期一早上有種**低落鬱悶的感覺**。」

Practice 17

> “Music helped chase away the **blues**.”

「音樂幫助她趕走**憂鬱情緒**。」

the blues = 一段低落、憂鬱或傷感的情緒

This is directly related to **blue** = sad.

9. **blues** = music genre (音樂) — 藍調音樂

Blues is also the name of a musical genre.

Practice 18

> “He enjoys listening to the **blues**.”

「他喜歡聽**藍調音樂**。」

Practice 19

> “The guitarist is known for playing the **blues**.”

「那位結他手以演奏**藍調**聞名。」

the blues = 源於非裔美國音樂傳統、具有特定和聲和表達風格的音樂類型

This is now a lexicalized noun and should be treated as a related lexical form rather than another ordinary adjective meaning of **blue**.

Related form: **bluish**

Bluish means somewhat blue or having a slight blue colour.

Practice 20

> “The shell had a **bluish** tint.”

「那個外殼帶有一點**藍色調**。」

Practice 21

> “The mountains looked **bluish** in the distance.”

「遠處的山看起來帶點**藍色**。」

bluish = 略帶藍色的；有點藍的

Related form: **blueness**

****Blueness**** means the quality or degree of being blue.

Practice 22

> “The ****blueness**** of the water was striking.”

「海水的****湛藍程度 / 藍色感****很引人注目。」

****blueness = 呈現藍色的性質或程度****

This is valid but much less frequent than ****blue****.

Useful expression: ****out of the blue — 突然；出乎意料地****

Practice 23

> “He called me completely ****out of the blue****.”

「他完全****出乎意料地 / 突然****打電話給我。」

Practice 24

> “The opportunity came ****out of the blue****.”

「這個機會****突然出現，完全出乎意料****。」

****out of the blue = 毫無預兆地、突然地****

This is one of the most important idioms built from ****blue****.

It should not be counted as a separate bare-word core meaning.

Useful expression: ****once in a blue moon — 極少；難得一次****

Practice 25

> “We only eat there ****once in a blue moon****.”

「我們只是****極少 / 難得一次****在那裡吃飯。」

Practice 26

> “He visits us once in a **blue moon**.”

「他**很少很少**來探望我們。」

once in a blue moon = 非常罕見地；隔很久才一次

Again, fixed idiom.

Useful expression: **black and blue** — 青一塊紫一塊

Practice 27

> “My leg was black and **blue** after the accident.”

「意外後我的腿**瘀青一片**。」

black and blue = 身體因碰撞而出現大量瘀傷

This remains related to physical colour.

Useful expression: **blue blood** — 貴族血統

Practice 28

> “The expression ‘**blue blood**’ traditionally refers to aristocratic ancestry.”

「**blue blood** 這個說法傳統上指**貴族血統**。」

blue blood = 貴族 / 上流社會血統

This is a fixed historical idiom, not another core sense of bare **blue**.

Useful compound: **blue-collar** — 藍領的

Practice 29

> “The area traditionally had many **blue-collar** workers.”

「這個地區傳統上有很多**藍領工人**。」

****blue-collar = 與體力、技術工種或工業工作有關的****

Again, this is a lexicalized compound rather than another bare-word sense.

Useful compound: ****blueprint****

****Blueprint**** historically referred to a type of blue technical drawing and now commonly means a detailed plan/model.

However, modern ****blueprint**** is lexicalized enough that it should be treated as its own word, not automatically folded into ****blue****.

Important distinction: ****blue vs navy****

****blue****

= the broad colour category.

****navy / navy blue****

= a very dark shade of blue.

So:

> all navy blue is blue

but:

> not all blue is navy.

Important distinction: ****blue vs turquoise****

****blue****

is the broad colour.

****turquoise****

is a blue-green colour.

In your passage:

> blue water

is a broad descriptive choice rather than a precise colour classification.

Important distinction: **blue vs sad**

sad

is the neutral direct adjective for unhappiness.

blue

is more informal and figurative.

> “I feel sad.”

direct.

> “I feel blue.”

more idiomatic, sometimes softer in tone.

Important distinction: **blue vs depressed**

blue

can mean temporarily sad or low.

depressed

can describe a more serious or persistent low mood and also has a clinical meaning in appropriate contexts.

So:

> feeling blue

does not automatically mean a depressive disorder.

Important distinction: **blue vs obscene**

For language/content:

blue

is an idiomatic adjective describing sexually explicit or indecent humour/content.

obscene

is stronger and more direct, referring to material considered offensively sexual or indecent.

> blue joke

often humorous/informal.

> obscene material

much stronger.

Countability note

When **blue** means the colour itself, it can be:

Uncountable/general

> “I like blue.”

Countable when referring to shades/types

> “The artist used several blues.”

= 幾種不同的藍色色調。

This is a useful learner distinction.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **blue**
 * **bluer**
 * **bluest**
 * **bluish**
 * **blueness**

Important lexical extension:

* **blues**

Useful idioms/compounds include:

* feel blue
 * the blues
 * out of the blue
 * once in a blue moon
 * black and blue
 * blue blood
 * blue-collar
 * blue joke

The Golden Manual says figurative meanings, useful fixed expressions, and lexical-family forms should be checked broadly while still distinguishing compounds/idioms from genuine meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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blue — colour	呈現藍色色調的；或藍色本身
blue — sad	感到悲傷、失落或情緒低落的；非正式
blue — sexually explicit	含有色情、性暗示或不雅內容的
blue — skin colour state	因寒冷、缺氧、瘀傷等而呈青藍 / 紫藍色；屬於 colour 義
the blue	藉藍色代指天空或海洋；較詩意
the blues — emotion	憂鬱、低落、傷感的情緒
the blues — music	藍調音樂；已成為獨立的音樂類型名稱
bluish	略帶藍色的
blueness	藍色的性質或程度

For your original sentence

> “...as it disappeared into the **blue water**.”

The exact meaning is:

blue = 呈現藍色色調的

So:

> **blue water**

= **藍色的海水**

The word is literal here and contributes to the calm visual image of the turtle quietly disappearing into the sea.

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **blue**:

1. **the colour blue / blue-coloured**
2. **figuratively sad or emotionally low**
3. **sexually explicit / indecent**

I would keep **blue from cold / bruised blue / the blue = sky or sea** under #1 as colour-based extensions, treat **the blues** as an important lexical-family branch with both emotional and musical meanings, and keep **out of the blue, once in a blue moon, black and blue, blue blood, blue-collar** as fixed expressions or compounds rather than inflate the bare-word core count.